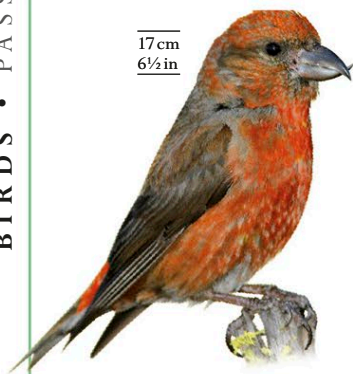


FINCHES AND RELATIVES

Finches of the family Fringillidae have diversified in Eurasia, Africa, and the tropical regions of the Americas. From thin-billed nectar-feeders to heavy-billed, seed-cracking grosbeaks and hawfinches, these birds have evolved to cope with a wide range of foods.



17 cm
6½ in

RED CROSSBILL
Loxia curvirostra

Crossbills use their uniquely crossed mandibles for extracting seeds from cones. This species is widespread in coniferous forests across the northern hemisphere.



12 cm
4¾ in

YELLOW-FRONTED CANARY
Serinus mozambicus

This bird belongs to a group of mostly yellow-coloured African serins and canaries. It is common south of the Sahara.



12 cm
4¾ in

EURASIAN GOLDFINCH
Carduelis carduelis

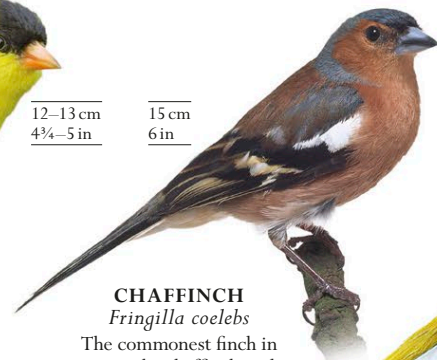
Goldfinches have a thinly pointed bill for taking seeds from the seed heads of tall plants, such as thistles. This species is widespread in Eurasia.



12–13 cm
4¾–5 in

AMERICAN GOLDFINCH
Carduelis tristis

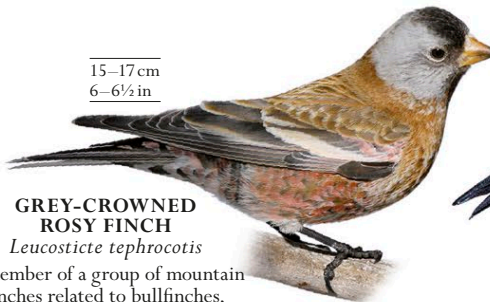
Bright yellow goldfinches and siskins have diversified in the Americas, especially in S. America. This migratory species is from N. America.



15 cm
6 in

CHAFFINCH
Fringilla coelebs

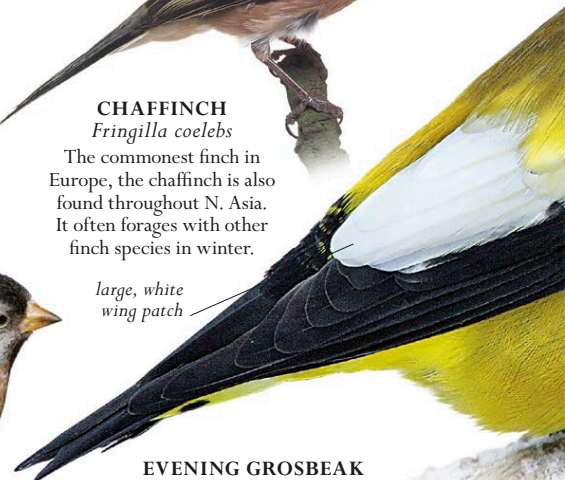
The commonest finch in Europe, the chaffinch is also found throughout N. Asia. It often forages with other finch species in winter.



15–17 cm
6–6½ in

GREY-CROWNED ROSY FINCH
Leucosticte tephrocotis

A member of a group of mountain finches related to bullfinches, this N. American species is an inhabitant of high, rocky landscapes.



large, white
wing patch

EVENING GROSBEEK
Hesperiphona vespertina

Grosbeaks of the finch family have a heavy seed-crushing bill, a feature they share with the unrelated grosbeaks of the cardinal-grosbeak family. This is a N. American species.

AMERICAN BLACKBIRDS AND RELATIVES

These American species of the family Icteridae superficially resemble the common blackbird, to which they are not related. As a group, these strong-billed birds are more closely related to finches. The bill has a powerful gaping action for prising apart tough food.



28–34 cm
11–13½ in

COMMON GRACKLE
Quiscalus quiscula

An opportunistic N. American species, this bird raids refuse dumps and corn crops. Its internally keeled bill can saw open acorns.



21–26 cm
8½–10 in

YELLOW-HEADED BLACKBIRD
Xanthocephalus xanthocephalus

This marshland bird of western N. America breeds in colonies and sites its nests over water, perhaps to deter predators.



17–24 cm
6½–9½ in

RED-WINGED BLACKBIRD
Agelaius phoeniceus

A N. American bird of marshy habitats, this colonial nester often breeds in the company of the larger, more dominant, yellow-headed blackbird.



19–26 cm
7½–10 in

EASTERN MEADOWLARK
Sturnella magna

A species from eastern N. America, this open-country bird builds a nest on the ground, covering it with a grass roof.



19–22 cm
7½–9 in

BROWN-HEADED COWBIRD
Molothrus ater

This N. American bird produces many eggs, laying them in the nests of other passerines. Its young are raised by many different host species.



18–20 cm
7–8 in

BALTIMORE ORIOLE
Icterus galbula

Feeding on insects and caterpillars in spring and summer, this species changes its diet in winter to include nectar and berries.

black head

orange
underparts



15–20 cm
6–8 in

BOBOLINK
Dolichonyx oryzivorus

This ground-nesting N. American bird gets its name from its bubbling flight song. It migrates to central S. America in winter.



37–46 cm
14½–18 in

CRESTED OROPENDOLA
Psarocolius decumanus

Like other tropical American oropendolas, this colonial species weaves long nests that hang from tips of branches in open forest.